RAJENDRA P N

LEAD DEVSECOPS & RELEASE ENGINEER | AZURE CLOUD, AZURE DEVOPS, AZURE BICEP, CI/CD & KUBERNETES

rajendran.scm@gmail.com
+1 (469) 926-4201
Dallas, TX
linkedin.com/in/rajendranelakurthi
rajendranelakurthi.github.io

Lead DevSecOps & Release Engineer with 10+ years of hands-on experience driving Azure Cloud infrastructure, CI/CD pipeline engineering, release management, DevSecOps security automation, and production operational support. Proactive, self-directed engineer experienced partnering closely with enterprise architects while independently taking ownership of assigned technical deliverables with minimal direction across US-daytime operations. Deep expertise across **Microsoft Azure, Azure DevOps, Azure Bicep, Terraform, Docker, and Kubernetes**, alongside Jenkins (Groovy), GitLab CI, and GitHub Actions to build, maintain, and improve automated delivery workflows. Embeds **DevSecOps controls—threat modeling, SAST/DAST, vulnerability management, and policy gates**—across release planning, change control, and production quality processes. Proven track record handling **production incidents, incident response, and root-cause troubleshooting** while integrating **Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenTelemetry** observability to proactively improve delivery velocity and operational reliability.

CERTIFICATIONS



GitLab Certified Associate



Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals



Microsoft Certified: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert



AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate



MuleSoft Certified Developer - Level 1

LEAD DEVSECOPS & RELEASE ENGINEERING HIGHLIGHTS

- **DevSecOps & Security Automation** Defined and championed enterprise DevSecOps frameworks across Azure Cloud and multi-cloud environments, embedding threat modeling, automated SAST/DAST scanning, secret detection, artifact signing, and policy-driven merge gates.
- **Azure IaC & CI/CD Pipeline Engineering** Built, maintained, and improved CI/CD pipelines across Azure DevOps, Jenkins, and GitLab CI alongside modular Azure Bicep and Terraform IaC for repeatable Docker and Kubernetes releases.
- **Release Planning, Quality & Governance** Supported release planning, release quality, and end-to-end delivery across dev, test, UAT, and production—enforcing semantic versioning, ServiceNow/CAB change control, ITIL approvals, go/no-go readiness, and automated rollbacks.
- **Production Support & Autonomous Ownership** Provided US-daytime production operational support and incident response, partnering closely with enterprise architects while independently driving troubleshooting, reliability improvements, and Prometheus/Grafana/OpenTelemetry observability.

BUILD, RELEASE & AUTOMATION SKILLS

DEVSECOPS & SECURITY AUTOMATION

Threat modeling, SAST, DAST, SonarQube, Fortify, Black Duck, Trivy, JFrog Xray, secret scanning, vulnerability management, signed artifacts, least-privilege IAM/Entra ID, compliance evidence

CI/CD PIPELINE ENGINEERING

Azure DevOps (Azure Pipelines, YAML), Jenkins, CloudBees, Groovy shared libraries, GitLab CI/CD, CircleCI, GitHub Actions, Maven, Gradle, JFrog Artifactory, Nexus, immutable packages

RELEASE PLANNING & QUALITY

Release planning, release quality, deployment readiness, semantic versioning, ServiceNow change requests, CAB approvals, ITIL processes, go/no-go gates, canary/blue-green rollouts, automated rollbacks

CONTAINERS & ORCHESTRATION

Docker, Kubernetes, AKS, EKS, OpenShift, Helm, ArgoCD, single & multi-tenant workload isolation, network policies, HPA/autoscaling, container performance tuning, zero-downtime deployments

AZURE CLOUD, BICEP & IAC

Microsoft Azure (AKS, VNet, Key Vault, App Service, Entra ID, Monitor), Azure Bicep, ARM Templates, Terraform, AWS, GCP, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, CloudFormation, drift remediation

PRODUCTION SUPPORT & INCIDENT RESPONSE

US-daytime operational support, production incident response, deployment & operational troubleshooting, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, ELK Stack, Splunk, CloudWatch, chaos & load testing

CLOUD SECURITY & ARCHITECTURE ALIGNMENT

Enterprise architect collaboration, autonomous technical ownership, Azure RBAC, AWS IAM, VPC/VNet segmentation, Azure Key Vault, Secrets Manager, Vault, security baselines, multi-cloud governance

SCRIPTING, SCM & ENABLEMENT

Python, FastAPI, Bash, PowerShell, Git (trunk-based, GitFlow, release/hotfix branching), Linux/RHEL/Ubuntu, AI-assisted engineering with human review, stakeholder risk reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead DevOps Engineer | AT&T Services Inc.

08/2023 - Present

Skills Used: Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, Azure Bicep, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, Python

- Defined, championed, and implemented an enterprise DevSecOps and release governance strategy across Azure Cloud and hybrid environments, partnering closely with enterprise architects while independently driving technical deliverables with minimal direction.
- Built, maintained, and improved CI/CD pipelines across Azure DevOps, GitLab CI, Jenkins, and CircleCI with staged build execution, automated quality gates, dependency caching, and embedded security checks at every SDLC stage.
- Authored modular Azure Bicep and Terraform Infrastructure-as-Code templates to provision secure Azure AKS, virtual networking, Key Vault, and multi-tenant Kubernetes/OpenShift environments with repeatable baseline parity.
- Drove shift-left DevSecOps practices through threat modeling, automated SAST/DAST scanning, secret detection, Bicep/Terraform IaC validation, and Docker container vulnerability management integrated directly into merge approvals.
- Supported release planning, release quality, and end-to-end software releases across development, staging, UAT, and production environments, governing readiness criteria, change control, and canary/rollback triggers.

- Provided US-daytime production operational support and incident response, proactively troubleshooting complex deployment, release, network, and Kubernetes operational issues to protect service availability.
- Collaborated with development and database teams to pinpoint performance bottlenecks through load, stress, and chaos testing, recommending code, query-tuning, and architecture optimizations.
- Integrated platform observability using Azure Monitor, Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenTelemetry for unified metrics, logging, and distributed tracing, proactively identifying reliability risks before production impact.
- Administered Git branching models (trunk-based, feature, release, hotfix) with protected branches, code ownership rules, immutable artifact versioning, and automated release status reporting for stakeholders.
- Built Python, PowerShell, and Bash automation tools to orchestrate repository onboarding, runner pool provisioning, release verification, and environment configuration across Linux build fleets, while incorporating AI-assisted code review and test drafting with human validation.

Senior DevOps Engineer | GlobalLogic

03/2023 - 08/2023

Skills Used: Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, Azure Bicep, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Python, Trivy, SonarQube

- Modernized legacy Jenkins pipelines into reusable Azure DevOps, GitLab CI, and CircleCI templates, embedding automated testing, static analysis, and compliance verification for rapid, reliable software delivery.
- Enforced DevSecOps governance across containerized release workflows, integrating SonarQube SAST, Trivy container image scanning, branch protections, and controlled approval gates.
- Designed and supported multi-tenant Docker, Kubernetes (AKS), and OpenShift deployment strategies with Helm charts, workload isolation, horizontal pod autoscaling, and zero-downtime rolling updates.
- Deployed and administered self-hosted, auto-scaling Linux and Windows build agents, optimizing executor concurrency, dependency caching, and pipeline throughput.
- Managed versioned package repositories, artifact feeds, and upstream promotion rules to enforce build-once/promote-many release traceability across environments.
- Partnered with QA and engineering teams to execute pre-release load and stress validations, troubleshooting container resource contention and application latency issues.
- Automated Azure Cloud and multi-environment configuration management and variable synchronization across dev, QA, staging, and production using Azure Bicep, Terraform, Ansible, and Puppet.
- Took independent ownership of assigned release quality and security improvements, mentoring engineering squads on Git branching governance, security-first coding practices, and automated rollback readiness.
- Documented release procedures, incident troubleshooting runbooks, and environment handoffs to standardize production operational support across distributed teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer II | Akamai Technologies

12/2021 - 03/2023

Skills Used: Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, Azure Bicep, AWS, GCP, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Python, PowerShell

- Built and maintained multi-cloud CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Terraform, and Azure Bicep to orchestrate application and infrastructure releases across Azure, AWS, and Google Cloud environments.
- Configured secure cloud IAM/Entra ID controls, VNet/VPC segmentation, secrets management, and environment-specific deployment groups for single and multi-tenant enterprise workloads.
- Coordinated complex cross-team release dependencies, change-control approvals, deployment sequencing, and automated rollback validation for production cutovers.
- Collaborated with application teams on load, stress, and failover testing across distributed systems, tuning auto-scaling policies, caching layers, and compute limits for peak reliability.
- Integrated delivery pipelines with monitoring and defect-tracking systems (Azure Monitor, CloudWatch, Slack, Teams, Jira), providing automated visibility into release health, SLA compliance, and deployment status.
- Published immutable, versioned artifacts to enterprise package managers and automated provenance tracking for release auditing and rapid recovery.
- Authored Python, PowerShell, and Bash automation scripts to standardize operational checks, security configuration validation, and recurring deployment tasks across Linux and Windows fleets.
- Led disaster recovery and chaos-style failover drills using cloud backup and recovery tooling to verify recovery point and recovery time objectives.
- Handled production operational support and investigated build, deployment, and distributed infrastructure incidents through telemetry analysis, authoring detailed operational runbooks and post-release reviews.

Senior DevOps Engineer / Senior SRE | Turvo India Pvt Ltd

04/2020 - 12/2021

Skills Used: Python, FastAPI, Jenkins, Groovy, JFrog Artifactory, Xray, SonarQube, Prometheus, Grafana, Ansible, Terraform, Kubernetes

- Designed and standardized DevSecOps CI/CD pipelines across CloudBees Jenkins and GitHub Actions, integrating SonarQube quality gates, JFrog Xray vulnerability scanning, and automated artifact promotion.
- Engineered Jenkins Groovy shared libraries to enforce semantic versioning, immutable Docker image tagging, and controlled artifact publication to private JFrog Artifactory repositories.
- Architected internal developer productivity APIs in Python (FastAPI) connecting Jenkins, Jira, and JFrog to automate project onboarding, release evidence gathering, and change tracking.
- Drove SRE and platform observability initiatives by building custom Python Prometheus exporters and deploying HA Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenTelemetry tracing stacks via Ansible roles.
- Partnered with backend and database teams during load and stress testing to isolate query latency, connection-pool saturation, and memory bottlenecks in distributed payment and logistics services.
- Provisioned and hardened AWS multi-account infrastructure using Terraform and CloudFormation, enforcing least-privilege IAM, MFA, Secrets Manager, and compliance policy controls.
- Maintained configuration consistency across production Kubernetes workloads and underlying Linux hosts using Ansible playbooks and Chef recipes.
- Coordinated production release readiness reviews, rollback execution, and incident triage, converting recurring failure modes into automated pipeline checks.
- Facilitated blameless post-release retrospectives with engineering and sprint managers to reduce escaped defects and continuously improve deployment reliability.

Senior DevOps Engineer | HCL Technologies

02/2019 - 04/2020

Client: Mercedes-Benz Research & Development India

Skills Used: Jenkins, Maven, Kubernetes, Helm, Ansible, CloudFormation, ELK, Shell Scripting, PowerShell, GitHub

- Designed and operated Jenkins and Maven CI/CD pipelines delivering RESTful Java microservices across Demo, Test, Pentest, UAT, and Production environments with strict security gates.
- Implemented centralized platform observability and log analytics using the ELK stack and CloudWatch to monitor application throughput, error rates, and database health during release windows.
- Standardized Kubernetes and Helm chart packaging across multi-namespace clusters, tuning pod resource requests, limits, and readiness probes for predictable runtime performance.
- Automated AWS infrastructure provisioning and configuration enforcement across Linux and Windows EC2 fleets using CloudFormation, Ansible, Puppet, and PowerShell.
- Integrated automated SAST/security scanning and least-privilege identity controls across migration and application release pipelines to meet enterprise security standards.

- Represented DevOps engineering in technical stakeholder reviews with international leadership in Germany, communicating release readiness, roadmap enhancements, and risk mitigations.
- Served as acting Scrum Master and release coordinator, managing sprint commitments, cross-team dependencies, and production cutover checklists.
- Supported enterprise load and failover testing during on-premises-to-AWS workload migrations, tuning auto-scaling and RDS database capacity for peak demand.
- Authored comprehensive release runbooks, environment dependency matrices, and recovery procedures to streamline operations handoffs.

DevOps Engineer | Mphasis Ltd

08/2016 - 12/2018

Client: HPE

Skills Used: Jenkins, GitLab, Terraform, Ansible, Chef, Python, Shell Scripting, Maven, Nexus, Splunk

- Built automated YAML- and Jenkins-based CI/CD pipelines with event-driven triggers for multi-tier API, database, and UI components across shared delivery platforms.
- Defined Git branching strategies (feature, integration, release, hotfix) with pull-request checks and release tags to enforce version traceability and code-promotion governance.
- Automated system configuration management, middleware deployments (Tomcat/JBoss), and environment baselines across Linux servers using Ansible, Chef, and Puppet.
- Authored and maintained modular Terraform templates and executed reviewed infrastructure changes through automated deployment pipelines.
- Managed build-agent fleets, Maven/Nexus artifact repositories, and environment-specific variable groups to isolate development, test, and production stages.
- Developed Python and Unix shell scripts to automate recurring build tasks, deployment verification, configuration audits, and log management.
- Configured centralized log monitoring and alerting in Splunk to identify deployment regressions, diagnose runtime failures, and speed up troubleshooting.
- Validated release packages, database scripts, and deployment prerequisites prior to controlled stage promotion and production cutovers.
- Documented build workflows, configuration procedures, and incident recovery guides to improve engineering team consistency and onboarding.

EDUCATION

B.Tech (2009-2013) in Information Technology
Prakasam Engineering College, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Kakinada